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Technical Architect

Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 27th September 2026



Reference number

480745

Salary

£64,811

National £64,811 or London £70,677

New entrants to the Civil Service will start their role on the salary band of £64,811 for National Roles or £70,677 for London Roles.

You may be eligible for an additional non-pensionable allowance following

the outcome of a Technical Capability and Skills assessment. Allowances vary by assessment outcome, with a maximum value of up to £12,894 (National) or £12,736 (London) available for candidates achieving the highest assessment rating.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

AI Directorate

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Bristol, Darlington, Leeds, London, Manchester, Wolverhampton

About the job

Job summary

[We are MHCLG](#)

Here at the Ministry of Housing, Communities & Local Government (MHCLG), we work on things that make a real difference to people's lives. Whether it's through the homes we live in, the work of our local councils, or the communities we're all part of, our work is at the top of the political agenda.

[Local AI](#) is a new team within MHCLG, working with councils to unlock the potential of artificial intelligence (AI) in local public services. We support the responsible adoption of AI across local government, focusing on practical tools that save time, reduce costs and improve services for residents.

Local AI's goal is not simply to introduce new technology. We work with councils and partners to solve real service challenges where AI can make the biggest difference.

Our work spans product development, service transformation, capability building and shaping the wider adoption of AI across local government. Recent examples include [Local Transcribe](#) our work supporting councils to [responsibly adopt AI](#), and looking at how AI can [play a role in temporary accommodation](#).

Joining Local AI offers a rare opportunity to help shape how one of the most significant changes of our time is applied in public services. You will work alongside experts from local and central government, academia and industry to test new ideas, deliver practical solutions and help improve outcomes for millions of people who rely on local services every day.

As a Senior Technical Architect, you will provide technical leadership for Local AI's growing portfolio of products and services. You will help shape technical

strategy, architecture and standards across products such as Local Transcribe, ensuring solutions are scalable, secure and sustainable. Working closely with multidisciplinary teams and delivery partners, you will support teams to make good technical decisions, manage complexity and build the foundations needed to scale AI across local government.

Find out more about our Digital teams and what they are working on through our [MHCLG Digital blog](#). Please note that MHCLG do not offer visa sponsorship and applicants will need a valid visa for the duration of your employment.

Job description

The Senior Technical Architect is accountable for the technical integrity and architectural direction of the services and platforms they support. As a Senior Technical Architect you ll:

- Work across multiple products, services and teams to solve complex technical challenges requiring broad architectural thinking and strategic leadership.

- Lead the technical design of systems and services, making and communicating architecture decisions that balance user needs, risk, cost and delivery outcomes.

- Define and assure target architectures, technology standards and design patterns to support scalable, secure and reusable solutions.

- Provide architecture governance and technical assurance, ensuring solutions align with departmental, cross-government and industry standards.

- Lead the design and adoption of AI-enabled services and platforms, ensuring solutions are secure, ethical, scalable and deliver measurable value.

- Build strong relationships across local government, central government and delivery partners to identify opportunities for reuse, alignment and shared platforms.

Person specification

As a Senior Technical Architect, you ll have experience with:

Architecture design across cloud and hybrid environments involving networking, security, authentication, presentation, middleware, databases, data platforms, APIs and integration technologies.

Architecture design informed through the use of principles, patterns, technical standards, governance and best practice, with experience using architecture modelling techniques and tools to communicate and assure technical designs.

Architecture design working with multidisciplinary delivery teams within agile, waterfall and hybrid environments throughout the service lifecycle, from discovery and concept through to implementation, live operation and continuous improvement.

Translating business, user and policy requirements into technical solutions with clear traceability, communicating complex technical concepts and architecture decisions effectively to a range of technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Artificial intelligence and automation technologies, with particular expertise in generative AI, AI assistants, large language models (LLMs), retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), AI agents, intelligent automation, AI governance and responsible AI adoption. Experience designing and scaling reusable AI solutions that deliver productivity and service improvements across large, complex organisations.

Cloud, data and security architecture: Knowledge and experience of cloud platforms (e.g. AWS and Azure), including SaaS, PaaS and IaaS solutions, cloud-native application deployment, scalability, performance, resilience and cost optimisation. Experience applying information security, data governance and compliance controls, including data privacy, data lifecycle management, disaster recovery, backup, monitoring and tooling such as Microsoft Purview and Log Analytics.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £64,811, Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government contributes £18,775 towards you being a member of the Civil

Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

At MHCLG we offer many benefits that range from tailored career pathways and flexible working to MyLifestyle Childcare Voucher and Cycle to Work Schemes. For more information, please click [here](#).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

Application and Selection

The application process will be split into 2 stages, testing the following Success Profiles:

Behaviours, **Experience**, **Technical**

Please ensure your CV does not contain any personally identifiable information.

Note: We do not consider direct CV applications. All applications must be submitted via the provided application link.

Stage 1: Sift (CV)

Experience: Your CV will be assessed against the criteria in the job description and person specification.

Most of our campaigns utilise multiple assessors and so it is possible that each of your answers would be viewed by different assessors.

Stage 2: Technical test

Shortlisted candidates will be asked to prepare for a 30 minute technical test.

Stage 3: Interview

Behaviours: Making effective decisions, Working together, Seeing the big picture.

Experience: Experience questions will be based around the essential skills and criteria as listed in the job description.

Technical: Technical questions will be based around the essential skills and criteria as listed in the job description.

Sift and Interview Dates

Sifting is envisaged to take place the week commencing 28th September 2026.

Interviews are currently being held remotely via videocall. This could be subject to change.

Group 1 Digital & Data Roles

MHCLG has implemented the Digital and Data capability framework for Group 1 roles. Applicants that are successful and have been offered a position will be required to complete a capability assessment after the interview.

MHCLG will honour completed capability assessments for this role from other Government Departments for existing civil servants on level transfer only. Please provide a copy of your capability assessment to the Hiring Manager when applying. If you have any queries on pay, please contact the Hiring Manager.

Each experience or technical skill is assessed between 1-3, representing working towards, at or above the job level requirements.

You are awarded a proficiency level accordingly, and you will be given opportunity to annually re assess your capability and potentially increase your overall remuneration, through payment of allowances, depending on level of assessed capability.

Candidates moving from another government department have the option to retain their current basic pay if this is within our pay band for the relevant grade.

GRADE 7 Group 1 Digital and Data salary

The basic pay for this role will be between £70,677 (London), £64,811(National). Candidates will usually be recruited to the median of the payscale.

A digital allowance of up to £12,894 (National) or £12,736 (London) may also be payable depending on the level of assessed capability, in order to meet the MHCLG overall targeted remuneration rate for the specific grade, location and capability rating.

For applicants in receipt of existing allowances, we will assess each case individually, but we would seek not to exceed the MHCLG overall targeted remuneration rate for the specific grade, location and capability rating for existing civil servants, the usual policy on level transfer and promotion will apply, subject to the statements above.

How We Recruit

[Find out everything you need to know before applying here..](#)

Applying

Sifting

Interview

Interview Results & Feedback

Reserve List

Near Miss

Civil Service Grades

We are a DCS, RIS & GPTWV employer

Reasonable Adjustments

Human

How to Apply

[What you need to know before applying.](#)

You must review the following information from the MHCLG Career's Site before submitting your application. This step is essential to ensure your eligibility for the role and that your application is completed correctly.

Security Clearance Requirements

Civil Service Nationality Requirements

Right to Work

Artificial Intelligence

Civil Service Code and Recruitment Principles

CV Declaration

Sponsorships

Salary and Grade

Existing Civil Servants

Conflict of Interest

Location and Flexible Working

Fixed Term Contracts

Internal Fraud Database - [Internal Fraud Register](#)

Appeals and Complaints

Conflict of Interest

Security Clearance Requirements

National Office: **BPSS SC**

London Office: **BPSS SC**

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Digital Data Jobs

Email : digitaldatajobs@communities.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : digitaldatajobs@communities.gov.uk

Further information

If you are unsure about any part of the process or require additional information about the post to enable you to progress your application, you should speak to the Resourcing team - Recruitment@communities.gov.uk. Candidates can appeal at any stage of the recruitment process if they believe there has been:

a procedural irregularity

an infringement of the Civil Service equal opportunities policy

exceptional circumstances which were not notified to the interview panel

which might have affected performance on the day.

It is important to note that these are appeals about the process not the decision. In the first instance, an appeal should be directed to the MHCLG Resourcing Hub at Recruitment@communities.gov.uk.

If the MHCLG Resourcing Hub is unable to satisfactorily resolve your complaint, you may contact put your complaint in writing to the Civil Service Commission, Room G8,1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ or by email to: info@csc.gov.uk

